



Best of Ireland & Scotland

Welcome & Tour Tips

Good to have you here. This page covers the practical things worth knowing before we meet in Dublin.

You do not need to remember everything. Once the tour begins, I'll guide everyone through things step by step.

For official timings, inclusions and documents, please refer to your Trafalgar information.

Before we meet in Dublin



Know your Dublin hotel and confirm your Day 1 meeting time & place from your welcome email.



Know how you are getting from the airport to the hotel before you leave home.



Keep your passport, medication, phone, charger and valuables in your day bag — not your main suitcase.

ARRIVAL IN DUBLIN



Where to be and when

The tour begins with a Welcome Meeting in Dublin. Your welcome email confirms the hotel and the exact time — aim to arrive with enough time to check in and settle before we start.



Welcome Meeting

Our first group get-together is at **5:00 PM** in the hotel lobby, ahead of the Welcome Dinner.

Before 5:00 PM is your own time — check in, freshen up, have a look around. Just plan to be back in the lobby on time for our group start.



Hotel check-in

Check-in is typically available from 3:00 PM. If you arrive earlier, most hotels will store your main luggage at reception until your room is ready.

If you have some time before check-in, it is a nice opportunity to explore a little at your own pace before the tour begins.



Airport transfers

Trafalgar offers complimentary Day 1 airport transfers at set times. Please check your joining documents and welcome email for the exact timings and where to meet.

Once you have collected your luggage and come through arrivals, look out for your Trafalgar host — they will be looking out for you too, so just make eye contact and introduce yourself.

Complimentary transfers run at set times and cannot be held — if you miss yours, official taxis from Dublin Airport are easy to find and the hotel is straightforward to reach.

If you have a private transfer booked through Trafalgar, the details and instructions will be in your joining documents.



Dublin Airport meeting points

These photos show the two Trafalgar meeting points inside Dublin Airport arrivals — for travellers using the complimentary Day 1 transfer only.

T1 photo

T2 photo

T1: After customs, look left for ICE Currency Exchange in the main arrivals hall.

T2: After customs, look straight ahead for the yellow sculpture in the concourse.

If you are on a private transfer, follow the details in your joining documents instead.

MUST KNOW



What stays with you

One habit makes travel days much easier: keep the important things in your day bag, not your main suitcase.



Passport & travel documents

Know where your passport is at all times, and keep it with you — not packed in your main suitcase — on days when we have a ferry crossing or cross a border.

It is also good habit to carry some form of ID on your person day to day: passport, national ID card or driving licence all work.



Day bag essentials

Your main suitcase goes into the coach hold on travel days and may not be accessible until you reach the hotel. Keep anything you might need during the day with you:

- Glasses, contact lenses or hearing aids
- Medication and prescription items
- Phone, charger and any cables
- Cards, cash and travel money
- A waterproof layer — this is Ireland and Scotland

A useful rule: if you would miss it for a few hours, it belongs in your day bag.

Entry & visa requirements can vary depending on your nationality. Your Trafalgar documents include guidance — I also recommend checking your government's official travel advice before departure to be safe.

GOOD TO KNOW



Before you pack

These are the details that tend to make the biggest practical difference.



Walking shoes

This tour covers a lot of ground on foot — castle grounds, old city streets, historic sites and longer sightseeing days. Comfortable, well-worn shoes make a real difference across the whole tour, not just on one day.

If you are unsure which pair to bring, bring your most comfortable ones.



Weather and layers

Weather across Ireland and Scotland can shift quickly — within a few hours, and from one region to the next. You might get a bit of everything in one day, which is fairly normal here.

A waterproof jacket you trust, a mid-layer, and comfortable shoes will do most of the heavy lifting. Forecasts are useful but treat them as a guide rather than a guarantee.



"Today's rain is tomorrow's whisky."

– A local favourite in both countries



Power adapters

Ireland, Northern Ireland and Scotland all use the same plug — the UK Type G, with three rectangular pins. One adapter covers the entire tour.

If you are travelling from outside the UK or Ireland, you will need one. A universal travel adapter with USB and USB-C ports is the simplest all-in-one solution.

[View plug type](#)

Packing

Pack for usefulness rather than volume. Most people bring more than they use — and on a tour with several hotel changes, lighter luggage is noticeably easier to live with.

We use audio listening devices on walking tours — disposable wired headphones are provided. These are not Bluetooth, so wireless earbuds will not connect. You are welcome to bring your own wired pair if you prefer.

On a tour of this length, most people are glad of a chance to do some laundry. We can usually arrange this at our two-night stays — most often Killarney and Glasgow.

Luggage allowance: 1 suitcase up to 23kg / 50lbs, plus 1 soft hand-luggage bag. The hand bag must be soft-sided with no wheels or telescopic handle — space on the coach is limited and soft bags fit much more easily. Label both bags clearly before leaving home. Suitcase delivery to your room can take around 30 minutes after check-in — keep toiletries, medications or anything you need on arrival in your hand luggage.



The rhythm of it

This itinerary takes us through some amazing parts of Ireland, Northern Ireland and Scotland — and you really do feel the shift between them as we travel.

Some days are about the journey itself. Looking out the window as the landscape changes completely over a few hours. Coastal roads, a ferry crossing, little towns appearing out of nowhere, weather moving across the hills, and stretches where people quietly stop talking and just watch the scenery roll past.

Other days are about slowing down and being somewhere properly — old city streets, castle grounds, Highland views, local pubs, historic sites, and enough time to wander a little rather than just ticking places off.

The weather is part of the experience too. Rain in the morning, sunshine by lunchtime, jacket back on by evening — that's fairly normal here, and it adds to the character of the place rather than taking away from it.

There will be some earlier starts and longer touring days, but most people settle into the rhythm surprisingly quickly. I'll always let you know what's coming up, what to bring for the day, and anything worth knowing before we set off.



On the coach

Seat rotation happens daily, and I'll explain the system clearly on Day One.

Snacks are absolutely fine. Just avoid hot food, hot drinks and anything likely to melt, spill or perfume the entire coach by lunchtime. Please keep your seat area tidy — it's a shared space and it makes a real difference to everyone's day.

On the day of our ferry crossing, your main suitcase travels with the coach — keep your day bag with you, and a layer handy for the sailing.

Seatbelts on whenever you are seated — it's a simple habit that matters.



Comfort stops

We plan regular comfort stops along the way. There may also be a WC on board the coach, but most people find the stops easier.

When getting on and off the coach, take your time and use the handrail.



Hotels vary

One night you may be in a modern hotel; the next in a more historic property with a different character and layout. That variety is part of travelling through Ireland and Scotland rather than staying in one standard hotel every night.

Air conditioning is not common in Ireland and Scotland — it is simply not part of the building culture here. If your room feels warm, reception can sometimes provide a fan.



Our Driver

Our Driver is a huge part of what makes the journey run smoothly — navigating a coach through Ireland and Scotland, including some of the narrower roads and longer touring days, takes real skill and concentration.

By the end of the tour, most groups have a genuine appreciation for just how much goes into it.



Tour timings & inclusions

Our days run to a schedule. Being ready on time — for departures, meals and activities — keeps things on track for everyone in the group.

I'll always let you know what's coming up and what to be prepared for. All we ask is that you're there on time, ready to go.



Security

Keep your passport, cards and valuables secure and close to you, particularly in busier city areas and at transport hubs. A small bag that stays close to your body is worth considering on busier sightseeing days.

A little awareness in crowded places goes a long way.

STAYING CONNECTED



WhatsApp

I use WhatsApp for simple reminders and day-to-day updates while we are travelling. It is optional, but it usually makes the small daily details easier.

1

Download and set up WhatsApp before you travel if you do not already use it.

[Download WhatsApp](#)

2

Save my number — it is in your welcome email, or use the WhatsApp link at the top of this page.

3

Send me a message with your name so I know you are set up.

Travelling with someone? It helps if both of you message me, just in case phones get separated during the trip.

Most hotels and many public places offer Wi-Fi.

If you are planning to rely on mobile data, it is worth checking roaming options with your provider before travel. Some people use an eSIM as a simple alternative for staying connected across multiple countries.

If you'd rather not use WhatsApp, that's fine — everything important will still reach you.

★ A few practical things for later

You do not need to make all of these decisions before we meet. They become much easier once you can see the pace of the tour and what suits you.

★ Optional experiences

Optional experiences are available throughout the tour, and in my experience they're often the moments that stick — a chance to go a bit further into the places we're already visiting, in a way that's hard to organise on your own.

I'll walk you through everything once we're underway. No pressure at all, but worth keeping an open mind.



Money & cards

Cards are widely accepted, but a small amount of cash can still be useful for smaller cafes, markets and local purchases.

The Republic of Ireland uses the Euro (€). Northern Ireland and Scotland use Pounds Sterling (£). You will cross between the two currency zones during the tour — small ATM withdrawals as you go are usually simpler than carrying large amounts of both from home.



Gratuities

Some gratuities are included in your tour price — portage and restaurant tips on included meals, for example. Tips for your Travel Director and Driver are separate unless pre-paid.

Guidance is in your Trafalgar documents, and you can ask me on tour if you are unsure. This does not need to be solved on the first morning.

CONTACT



Questions before we begin?

Save my contact now, and keep your official joining instructions somewhere easy to find. That is enough for the moment.

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WhatsApp is usually the easiest way to reach me during the trip.

Instagram



Homepage



Email me



Urgent before departure?

Before the tour begins, I may occasionally be travelling or finishing another tour, but I will always get back to you as soon as I can.

If something is time-sensitive before Day 1, please check your welcome email for European Guest Services contact details.

Once we are together, things usually become much more straightforward day to day.



Final note

Ireland, Northern Ireland and Scotland — there is a lot ahead of us, and I'm looking forward to every part of it. 🍀 See you in Dublin.

A personal guide from your Travel Director. For official timings, inclusions and operational details, refer to your Trafalgar documents.